

Aws Abdulfattah

Engineering Manager • Player-coach • Fintech & Payments

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Engineering leader who still writes the code. I hire, I set the architecture, and I own the outcome.

At **Cardyiq** I built the engineering function from zero: hired and lead **5 engineers** (backend, frontend, mobile, UI/UX, QA), own hiring and budget, and shipped **30 mobile releases in 6 months at 99.9% uptime**. I inherited a product that only ran over a VPN and rebuilt it in production; I also pushed the **business model** from entry-passes to points, which unlocked expansion from gyms to **150+ venues across 6 cities**, and personally secured the sponsorship for the company's largest 2026 event.

In parallel, a Senior Software Engineer at **Qi Card** (Iraq's largest fintech), where I built the **Tasdid** payment service and **Tasdid+ (1M+ users)**, and mentor juniors and university students through the Qi Card-AUIB programme.

Nine years as an architect before software — managing contractors, budgets and post-conflict housing reconstruction for UNOPS in Anbar. I have been responsible for things that matter for a long time.

SKILLS

Leadership — Hiring, budget, performance, architecture, incident command. Player-coach — I still review and write code.

Hiring & interviewing Team of 5 (BE/FE/Mobile/UX/QA) Budget ownership Mentorship Incident response

Business

Business-model design Regulatory (Central Bank of Iraq) Partnerships & sponsorship Stakeholder management

Engineering — Still hands-on, daily.

TypeScript JavaScript Python SQL React

Payments

Card tokenization Idempotency Reconciliation SuperQi / Alipay APIs Wayl

Infrastructure & delivery

Docker GitHub Actions Dokploy Linux / VPS Read replicas & failover

AI

OpenAI API Gemini Coding agents n8n Token/cost optimization

Speaking & teaching — Toastmasters; presented to 1,000+; teach at the Qi Card-AUIB programme.

EXPERIENCE

Cardyiq — Founding Engineer & Technical Lead

September 2025 — Present • concurrent, equity
Baghdad, Iraq

- **Built the engineering organisation from zero.** Sole owner of hiring, offers and budget for the technical team; hired and lead 5 engineers across backend, frontend, mobile, UI/UX and QA.
- Shipped **30 mobile releases in 6 months at 99.9% uptime** (8 months). Introduced CI/CD from nothing — Docker, GitHub Actions, Dokploy — and a release process the team owns without me.
- Ran the rebuild of an agency-delivered product that failed at launch (VPN-only access, no caching, no pipeline, cash-only payments) **in production, without downtime**, while onboarding the team that would maintain it.
- Owned incident response. Recovered a data-loss incident with **zero records lost** by promoting a read replica; afterwards changed alerting so partial degradation is detected, not discovered.
- Drove the **business-model change** from entry-passes to points, which unlocked expansion from gyms to pools, padel and equestrian venues: **150+ venues, 6 cities, 1,200 subscribers, ~\$53K GMV in 7 months**.
- Secured event sponsorship covering a major share of costs for the company's largest 2026 padel tournament.
- Still hands-on: payments integration, architecture, code review. Player-coach by choice.

Qi Card — Senior Software Engineer — Billing

November 2024 — Present
Baghdad, Iraq

- Billing team at Iraq's largest fintech. I build inside **SuperQi**, Qi Card's super-app, on an Alipay-based mini-app runtime. Promoted to Senior in March 2026.
- Built **Tasdid** (the pay-with-Qi payment service third parties integrate) and **Tasdid+** (the consumer bill-payment mini-app): **1M+ users, ~500K transactions/month**.
- Owned the regulatory relationship on my surface area: designed and defended a P2P invoicing flow through **Central Bank of Iraq** review; implemented card payments in Tasdid+ to meet CBI's rule that any government bill be payable by any card.
- Built **Jabi+** (merchant mini-app: transactions, statements, payroll, supplier payments, Excel export) and **e-Psule** (trilingual Kurdistan Region billing).
- **Mentor and teach** — junior engineers on the team, and university students through the Qi Card-AUIB programme. Promoted to Senior, March 2026.

- Retained by 5 startups to integrate Iraq's payment rails — **Tasdid (pay-by-Qi)** and **Wayl** — into mobile and web products. Clients include Orivo, 3aljni and Skincare by Self.
- I built the Tasdid service itself, so integrations land first-time-right: correct redirect/webview handling, idempotency, webhook reconciliation, and checkout flows that don't lose users mid-payment.

- One of four engineers on a weekly meal-ordering platform; took over both backend and frontend.
- Cut hosting costs 4× — **\$200/month to \$50/month** — through infrastructure and deployment changes.
- Built the deployment pipeline, and a Telegram bot serving as notification system and delivery tracker, removing manual coordination from daily operations.

- Turned my own master's thesis into a company. Built a 3D property-visualisation web platform (Three.js, React Three Fiber, React, Tailwind) to **~\$60K in revenue**.
- Automated the Autodesk Revit → web delivery pipeline with Dynamo and Python, removing manual model preparation.
- R&D: a pipeline converting 360° captures (Insta360 SDK, Python) into interactive **3D Gaussian Splatting** scenes for real-estate and photography use.
- Wound down. The market was too small, funding ran out, and splatting quality at that time did not scale. **1st Prize, The Station Foundation Incubator; Most Innovative Startup Founder, CS50x Baghdad**. Presented HAWSR on stage to an audience of 1,000+.

- Managed reconstruction of housing for families displaced by the ISIS conflict in Anbar — contractors, budgets, delivery schedules and BIM coordination under field conditions. Wrote code nights and weekends throughout, and joined my first startup engineering role before the contract ended.

SELECTED WORK

Tasdid & Tasdid+ — National Bill Payment (Qi Card)

2024 — Present

Tasdid is the pay-with-Qi payment service: third-party applications integrate it to accept Qi Card payments without handling card data. **Tasdid+** is the consumer mini-app on top — pay government and private bills across many providers through one interface. **1M+ users, ~500K transactions/month**. SuperQi (Alipay-based) APIs for authentication, bill enquiry, invoice display, wallet and card-tokenized payments. Svelte architecture separating UI from state; caching and progressive loading to absorb providers with very different response times. Designed against Central Bank of Iraq requirements.

NotifyX — Open-source Notification Infrastructure · github.com/awsdang/notifyx

2025 — Present · Open source

Multi-channel notification platform: FCM, APNS, HMS and Web Push behind one API, with plug-and-play SDKs for web, Flutter and React Native. Backend API, worker and scheduler in **Node.js, BullMQ, Redis and PostgreSQL (Prisma)** — asynchronous job processing, scheduling, retries and queue orchestration. Load-tested with k6 at **~150 messages/sec per worker**. React admin dashboard for delivery operations.

EDUCATION

Turing College —Certificate, AI Engineering

October 2025 — 2026

Completed. Capstone: Maaahr, an AI interview-practice platform, later extended to live voice.

University of Technology —B.Sc., Architectural Engineering

October 2012 — July 2017

University of Ljubljana —Erasmus Exchange, MSc Information Management (coursework & thesis)

October 2020 — October 2021

Coursework and thesis completed remotely; degree not conferred (visa denied during COVID-19). The thesis was commercialized as **HAWSR**.

AWARDS, CERTIFICATIONS, COMMUNITY & LANGUAGES

1st Prize — Incubator Program The Station Foundation · 2022	AI Engineering Turing College · 2026	The Station Hackathon 2023 — Present	Arabic Native
Most Innovative Startup Founder in Baghdad CS50x Baghdad · 2022	Machine Learning for Inverse Graphics & AI MIT · March 2024	Startup Weekend Baghdad 2017 — 2023	English Professional — IELTS 7.5–8
	Python — AI & Machine Learning 10K Arab AI Developers Initiative · January 2024	Toastmasters International 2020 — 2021	Dutch Beginner
	Three.js Journey Bruno Simon · July 2022	Qi Card × AUIB 2025 — Present	